



MUCOCELE

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An oral mucoccele, also known as an oral mucous cyst, is a painless blister of the mucous membrane. They are typically located on the lip or the mucosal surfaces of the mouth, and as their name indicates, they contain mucous. Oral mucocceles most frequently appear in individuals under 30 years.

Clinically, a mucoccele will typically appear as a solitary, well-demarcated dome-shaped lesion with a clear to bluish hue, with a diameter ranging from 1mm to 2cm. Mucocceles commonly occur on the inner surface of the lower lip, the gingiva, buccal mucosa, tongue, and the floor of the mouth. A mucoccele on the floor of the mouth is known as a ranulae. The cause of mucocceles relates to trauma of a salivary gland or obstruction of a gland duct, which results in the formation of the cyst and retention of mucous.

Diagnosis of a mucoccele is concluded from the patient's subjective history and physical examination. It is common for a patient to report a history of a soft, round, and smooth lesion that spontaneously swells and pops on the lower lip or inside the mouth. However, ultrasound can be used to evaluate the lesion and an excisional biopsy can confirm the diagnosis.

Treatment for mucocceles is usually unnecessary, as most cyst rupture on their own. However, it is possible for lesions to recur. For persistent or large mucocceles, treatment options include cryotherapy, laser treatment, or conservative surgical excision to remove the minor salivary gland and mucous deposit. If noted to be a source of trauma, it is recommended to counsel individuals to stop biting their lips or sucking on their cheeks.

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